Peer Founder Call — Daniel Avellaneda (Blurt AI)

Date: 2026-04-23 | Type: Peer founder conversation + live app test | Not a user interview

> **Context:** Daniel is the founder of Blurt AI — a SaaS tool that helps creators copy viral videos (paste link, get auto-transcription + frame-by-frame breakdown + AI script assistant). Currently doing ~$1-2K/day, scaling toward $100K/month. This was a peer founder conversation, not a traditional user interview. Tiffany showed him PixSort live and got product feedback + learned his UGC creator strategy.

Live App Test — Feedback

Issues Flagged

- **"Apple Photos" terminology is confusing.** Daniel thought it meant the MacBook desktop Photos app, not the iPhone camera roll. Suggested changing to "camera roll" everywhere. High priority fix.
- **"Send photos" vs "Move photos" labeling** — unclear what happens when you tap "send to photos" inside an album. Needs clearer copy.

Positive Reactions

- UI design: *"I like the brown corners of everything. Looks very clean."*
- Screenshots category: was literally deleting screenshots for storage that day — immediately relevant
- AI search / cleanup tab: liked the concept of searching photos by description
- Auto-categorization of food and travel photos: noticed and appreciated

Product Ideas (Unprompted)

- **Swipe-to-delete (Tinder for photos):** *"That went viral for apps. That's a viral feature."* Swipe left to delete — shareable, brain-rot-friendly hook in its own right.
- **Swipe up/down to organize:** Companion interaction — swipe up to keep/assign a photo to a category, swipe down to skip. Turns camera roll cleanup into a fast, gesture-driven experience rather than a tap-heavy one. Both swipe interactions together create a genuinely fun, repeatable loop that is easy to show in a 15-second video.
- **Viral content angle — show it organizing in real time:** *"Delete the app, reinstall it, show it organizing all the photos in real time."* Clean before/after in one take.

- **Brain rot angle:** Extreme search scenario (e.g., "my dad got caught cheating" → AI finds the photo) — absurd but the format consistently goes viral.

DM After the Call

> **DANIEL — INSTAGRAM DM (POST-CALL)**
>
> "So I want to share this because I feel like I did it. I wanted to build an app like this. Like I was like this is so cool. Like I like the photo app of like being able to swipe and delete and organizing. Like for the past literally it's been on my mind for like the past week. I was like I ran out of storage. I need to organize, delete this. I like the organization. But I think like swiping like I want to be able to organize it myself. And I wanted to do it with speed. So for example you my in this why haven't organized it? It's like I was like it's not worth my time to spend two hours to organize all my stuff. Um but if I can speed it up and then have it organized like with swipe. Swipe left. That'll be worth it. Like I I was like I'll actually organize it then. Um another one would be like let's say like he says like it's not worth your time as well. It's like let's say I shot like a bunch of B roll UGC videos and I don't want necessarily AI to organize it. Like for example, yesterday, I recorded, let's say, overall, 20 different videos. I want to have a cool option to be able to like, I know, this one, I don't want to I want to keep, swipe, keep, swipe, keep, swipe, boom. And then I finally have the ones I want. If that makes sense. So, like, for me, that's how I would use it. I would, like, record a bunch of videos, then, go to the app and be like, swipe. No, swipe. yes, No, yes, no. And then, I feel like, it's a lot easier to like push that to creators as well. It's like, look, you just recorded a bunch of videos. Here's the bad ones. Again, this is just my opinion. You don't have to build the feature out but I think for me, that that would be really, really valuable. Um and I feel like a lot of the the the agencies that I connected with, I feel like they would want to use it in that sense as well."

UGC Creator Strategy — Daniel's Playbook

This is the most actionable part of the call for PixSort's launch strategy.

Creator Sourcing

- Best performers came from his **personal brand followers** — they cared more because they had a relationship with him
- Upwork: 1 out of 10 was actually good — use only for supplemental testing
- Sweet spot: low-follower accounts with strong, consistent content — check video-by-video variance before hiring

Payment Structure

- **Test run first:** 5 videos for $100 — cuts losses on non-deliverers
- **Performance bonus:** $100 per 100K views / $1,000 per million views
- Do NOT over-pay upfront — $250 upfront did not motivate creators with no personal connection
- 16-year-old from his following made a 400K-view video by changing one word in the headline

Account Strategy

- Creators post from **fresh accounts**, not their personal profiles
- Post from **different geographic locations** to reach different regional audiences (e.g., Australia creator targets AU/NZ)
- **Warm up accounts daily** before going for the viral push — account needs posting momentum first
- Set hard expectation upfront: video out within 5 days or no payment / end the engagement

Viral Format Mechanics

- One winning angle can be milked (same structure, same caption) until it dies — then find the next angle
- His winning format: *"I've been creating content for X years — content on easy mode"* (no talking, just showing the software)
- Once you have a proven format: give it to influencers verbatim. *"I already made this viral video — just copy it word for word."* Much easier sell.
- **Test angles on your own account first** ("trial roles") — if it hits 5K+ views, hand it to creators

---

Pricing Discussion

- Blurt: $40/month basic, $60/month pro, $300/year basic, $400/year pro
- Started by undercutting competitor Poppy (yearly only) by going monthly
- Advice: *"Depends who you're targeting — look at what other photo apps charge."*
- Yearly plans that front-load savings work well when ROI is clear to the user

---

Key Quotes

> *"I like the brown corners of everything. Looks very clean."*

> *"The fact that I was able to analyze that and put them all there automatically — that's nice."*

> *"I would have a UGC creator delete the app, show it organizing all the photos in real time."*

> *"Tinder swipe for deleting photos — that went viral. That's a viral feature."*

> *"Once you have a viral video, tell influencers: look, I already made this — just copy it word for word."*

> *"It's not worth my time to spend two hours to organize all my stuff. But if I can speed it up and then have it organized with swipe — that'll be worth it." (DM)*

> *"I would record a bunch of videos, go to the app and be like, swipe. No, swipe. Yes, No, yes, no." (DM)*

Product Flags for Spencer

Flag	Source
Rename "Apple Photos" → "camera roll" everywhere in the app	Live test — Daniel genuinely confused, thought it was the MacBook desktop app
Clarify "Send photos" vs "Move photos" — labeling unclear inside albums	Live test confusion
Swipe-to-delete (left) + swipe-to-organize (yes/no) — gesture-driven interaction layer	Call + unprompted follow-up DM; also mentioned agencies would want this

---

Actionable Next Steps

FOR TIFFANY — THIS WEEK

- Post first test angle on your own account — no talking, show the app organizing in real

FOR SPENCER — PRODUCT

- Replace all "Apple Photos" references with "camera roll"

time

- Identify 2-3 creator candidates from your following for a 5-video / $100 test run
- Ask sister to start posting from a US-based account to hit domestic audience
- Study Daniel's winning Blurt video format — apply the "X years, easy mode" structure to PixSort
- Watch Starter Story + Super Wall on YouTube for app growth inspiration

- Rewrite "Send photos" / "Move photos" button copy — make the action obvious
- Add select-all to album view (also flagged by Sayu)
- Add swipe yes/no to organize + swipe left to delete to product backlog

CONTENT STRATEGY

- Test angles yourself first — post daily, see what hits 5K+
- Once a format wins, hand it to creators verbatim
- Bali account targets SE Asian / creator audience; US account targets domestic
- Warm up fresh accounts for 1 week before pushing viral content
- Consider brain rot angle — extreme AI search scenario for reach

CREATOR HIRING (WHEN READY)

- Start with people who already know you — from followers or warm network
- Payment: $100 for 5-video test run first
- Bonus structure: $100 per 100K views
- Set deadline upfront: video live within 5 days or engagement ends
- Do NOT pay large amounts upfront to cold creators

Call notes by Tiffany Parra — PixSort co-founder